

Mason Russell, LHP, Arizona

2026 Stats: 2.25 ERA/4 IP/1.500 WHIP/6 K/4 BB/1.5 K:BB

6-0, 203

Metrics

FB: 87.8/16.4 IVB/-5.1 HB/-5.2 VAA/5.9 ext/6.1 relH/43.1 AA/30% zone/23.3% usage/2330 rpm

CT: 83.6/4.1 IVB/1.3 HB/-7.3 VAA/37.1 AA/40.9% zone/51.2% usage/2560 rpm

CB: 78.4/-12.8 IVB/-0.2 HB/-10.09 VAA/50.3 AA/30% zone/23.3% usage/2490 rpm

CH: 83.4/11.5 IVB/-13.5 HB/-6.9 VAA/35.6 AA/0% zone/2.3% usage/1610 rp

Write-up

Mason Russell is an interesting case study of usage, stuff, and command in draft projection. He is a big bodied lefty with average shapes but big supination traits that show upside. Unfortunately, he only had 4 innings this year and 11.1 total in the NCAA. The command has not been present as he has walked 9 batters across those 34 outs. The velo also leaves something to be desired, but it is not hard to see a good reliever in the traits.

The FB is a cut ride shape that he gets glove side where the cut plays up into the hands of righties. He kept it around the zone as well, but it failed to get chases outside of the zone. The 50% CSW is impressive as 4 CS and 1 whiff were garnered in the 10 pitches thrown. The velo is below average but as a lefty, that is often ok. If he can bulk on a touch more velo, sitting 90 instead of topping it, this could be a big league average pitch. 40/45 pitch

The CT is the hallmark of the arsenal, a diving pitch with a good glove side/depth combo. He zoned it well, keeping it in the lower half and getting whiffs when buried. It drifted middle a bit instead of painting corners, but the most important part of throwing strikes is hitting the zone. A small target shift can put Russell on the shadow rather than the heart. Batters swung and fouled off a lot of cutters, suggesting that the pitch has enough movement to get hitters off of it, but also that it is not protected enough to get whiffs on its own. 45/45+ pitch

The CB is a downer that gets little gloveside and often drifts into the armside curve shape which is unique at the collegiate level. He struggled to land it consistently for strikes, spiking the pitch often.

The traits on the pitch are once again above average, but the lack of consistent command, especially to RHH is slightly troubling. 45/45+ pitch

Russell threw 1 change in 2026 and it had good fade off the FB but he slowed his arm to get to the speed difference. I am not sure if this is the CH iteration that Russell needs long term, maybe a splitter would play better into his release characteristics. 30/30 pitch